

PLAYPTL — Project Flow Document

Platform: playptl.com

Document Type: System Flow & User Guide

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1. Introduction

PlayPTL is a tennis league and tournament management platform. Admins run the full season — players register, group matches are scheduled, standings are calculated, and playoffs complete the tournament.

This document explains:

- The overall system flow
 - What admins do and in what order
 - What players do
 - What happens in each tournament phase
 - Important rules the system enforces
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2. Platform Overview

2.1 Three types of users

User	Who	What they do
Admin	Tournament organizer / PTL staff	Tournament setup, roster management, match scheduling, results, playoffs
Player	Registered tennis player	Manage profile, join tournaments, play matches, enter scores
Visitor (Public)	No login required	View league standings, schedules, and charity pages

2.2 Where users go after login

- **Admin** → Admin Panel (/admin)
- **Player** → My Profile (/player/my-profile)
- **Visitor** → Public pages (/league/..., /charity)

3. System Structure

The system follows a **tree structure**. Top to bottom:

```
TOURNAMENT (Season) ■ ■■■■ DIVISION (Group Card) ■ Example: "Voyagers Singles 3.5" ■
■ ■ ■■■■ SUBGROUP ■ ■ Example: Group A, Group B, Group C ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■■■■ PLAYERS
(registered in this subgroup) ■ ■ ■ ■■■■ GROUP MATCHES (round-robin within subgroups)
■ ■ ■ ■■■■ PLAYOFFS (knockout bracket after group stage) ■ ■■■■ (more divisions – 4.0
Singles, Doubles, etc.)
```

Simple example

Tournament: PTL Spring 2026

Division: Voyagers Singles (skill 3.5)

Subgroups: Group A, Group B, Group C

Players: 5–8 players per subgroup

Matches: Round-robin per subgroup — Week 1, Week 2, ...

Playoffs: Top players enter knockout after group stage

4. Admin Flow — Running a Full Tournament

PHASE 1: Initial setup (once per season or as needed)

Step 1 — Create subgroups

Admin panel → **Groups**

Create subgroup names such as "Group A", "Group B", "Group C". These are templates linked to divisions later.

Step 2 — Create divisions (Group Cards)

Admin panel → **Subgroups (Group Cards)**

Each division defines skill level + format:

- **Name:** Voyagers Singles, Champions Doubles, etc.
- **Format:** Singles or Doubles
- **Skill tier:** 3.0, 3.5, 4.0, etc.

- **Playoff format:** Top 4 seeds to Quarterfinals, others to Round of 16, etc.
- **Attach subgroups:** Link Group A, B, C

Step 3 — View and manage players

Admin panel → **Players**

- Full list of registered players (singles and doubles registrations shown together)
- **Login as** column — whether the account was created as Singles or Doubles (account type; does not change if they later play another format in a tournament)
- **Active tournaments** — tournaments the player is currently in (in-season window)
- Search, tournament filter, pagination
- Edit or delete player records

Note: New players register via the public website or their player profile (**Choose League**). Admin does not create new registrations from the admin panel; admin manages existing players and moves them between subgroups.

PHASE 2: Create a new tournament

Step 4 — Create the tournament

Admin panel → **Tournaments** → Create

Field	Meaning
Tournament name	PTL Spring 2026
Start date	Season start
End date	Season end
Status	Active / Upcoming / Completed
Entry fee	Separate singles and doubles fees (online payment)
Attach divisions	Which group cards belong to this tournament

Important: Tournament start/end dates bound the whole season. Group matches and playoffs should fall within this window (or extend the tournament).

Step 5 — Open Tournament Management

Admin panel → **Tournaments** → Manage

Each attached division is listed. Work through each division separately.

PHASE 3: Per division (repeat Steps 6–12)

One tournament can have multiple divisions (3.5 Singles, 4.0 Singles, Doubles, etc.). Repeat the steps below for each.

Step 6 — Players join via registration

Players register through:

- Public **Register** page (/register), or
- Player **Choose League** after login

Admin assigns registered players to subgroups from **Subgroups & Players**:

- Move players between Group A, B, C
- **Doubles only**: Assign a **partner** from players in the same subgroup who do not already have a partner
- Partners are scoped **per tournament and division** — the same person can have different partners in different tournaments at the same time
- Moving a player to a subgroup also moves their doubles partner

Rule: One player may be in only **one singles division** or **one doubles division** per tournament.

Step 7 — Review subgroups and roster

Page: Subgroups & Players

- See which player is in which subgroup
- Move players between subgroups
- Add new subgroups
- For doubles, link partners before or after subgroup assignment
- Unassigned players appear in a separate section until placed in a subgroup

Step 8 — Schedule group matches

Page: Matches

Prerequisites:

- Tournament start/end dates set
- At least 2 players per subgroup

- All players assigned to subgroups

How to schedule:

1. Select **Group start date** (within tournament window)
2. Click **Schedule matches**
3. System creates round-robin matches for **all subgroups (A, B, C)**
4. Matches are split into **Week 1, Week 2, Week 3...**
5. Set **Group end date** afterward (on or after the last match date)

Match calendar rules:

- Matches only **Monday through Saturday**
- **No matches on Sunday**
- Odd number of players (e.g. 5) → one bye per round — that player has no match that week
- Maximum one match per player per week

If the tournament window is too short:

If matches would extend past the tournament end date, the system shows a warning — extend the tournament via **Edit Tournament** first.

Cancel matches:

Cancel this group matches deletes all scheduled matches for the division and emails affected players. Not available after playoffs have started.

Step 9 — Enter match results

Results can come from:

- **Admin** on the Matches page
- **Player** via My Matches (photo upload + score)

Standings update when results are recorded.

Step 10 — Check standings / points

Page: Points

- Full division ranking
- Filter by subgroup
- Points system:
 - Straight-sets win → Winner 14, Loser up to 8
 - Three-set win → Winner 12, Loser up to 8
 - Walkover → Winner 10, Loser 0

Step 11 — Qualifier (playoff paths)

Page: Qualifier

Unlocks when: At least one group match has a result.

The system suggests paths from standings:

Path	Meaning
Quarter	Seed directly into quarterfinals
Pre-Q / Round of 16	Play Round of 16 first
Pre-Pre-Q	Pre-Pre-Quarter round first
Eliminated	Out of playoffs

Admin can review, adjust, and add notes. Saving generates the playoff bracket.

Step 12 — Playoffs

Page: Playoffs

Before scheduling:

- Qualifier paths saved
- Tournament end date allows playoffs to fit
- Group matches completed

Playoff schedule:

1. **Playoff start date** — must be **after** group matches end
2. **Playoff end date** — last possible final date
3. Click **Schedule matches** → playoffs start; group scheduling locks

Typical rounds:

Pre-Pre-Q → Round of 16 → Quarterfinals → Semifinals → Final

Admin enters results and uses **Advance winners** to move players to the next round.

Close playoffs:

When all results are final → **Playoff close** → scores lock.

Step 13 — Finish tournament

From League Management, **Finish** the tournament → season officially complete.

5. Player Flow

5.1 New player — Registration

Page: /register (public)

1. Choose **Singles** or **Doubles**
2. Enter details — name, email, password, phone, city, skill level, age group
3. Select a **tournament**
4. System assigns a division based on skill level (tier bucket — e.g. 3.25 maps to the 3.5 tier)
5. Pay online via **Stripe**
6. Account is created — log in

Doubles registration:

- Partner details required
- Division uses average skill of both players
- Partner receives an email to set up their account

5.2 After login — My Profile

Section	Purpose
Personal Information	Name, phone, photo, skill level; Active Tournaments with dates and division/subgroup
Choose League	Register for additional tournaments (with payment)
Password & Security	Change password
My Matches	View and manage scheduled matches (all active tournaments)
Upload Image	Upload match photos

Active tournaments: All in-season tournaments the player is registered in are shown with window dates. Upcoming tournaments appear separately.

5.3 Join another tournament

Use **Choose League**. Skill level must be set under Personal Information first.

5.4 When matches appear

Matches appear in **My Matches** only after **admin has scheduled** them.

The page shows:

- Active tournaments the player is in
- Upcoming matches in calendar style
- Opponent name, date, time, venue
- Playoff matches if qualified

5.5 Match flow (player)

Admin schedules match ↓ Player sees match (My Matches) ↓ Player sets or updates venue / date / time ↓ After the match – PHOTO UPLOAD required ↓ Enter score (sets or walkover) ↓ Standings update (public league page)

Player rules:

- Score cannot be entered without a photo upload
- Scores stay hidden from other players until entered (privacy)
- A player may have matches in multiple active tournaments on the same day

5.6 View standings

No separate standings page for players. Use the public league page:

URL: /league/{tournament-name}/{division-name}

Tabs: Standings, Schedule, Playoffs bracket.

5.7 Playoffs (player)

Players do not self-register for playoffs. If they qualify from group stage:

- Playoff matches appear in **My Matches**
- Same flow — photo upload → enter score

6. Registration Rules

Rule	Detail
Skill → Division	Player skill level determines division assignment

Doubles skill	Average of both players' skill levels
One format per tournament	One singles OR one doubles division per tournament
Multiple tournaments	Player may join different tournaments simultaneously
Different partners	Different doubles partner allowed in each tournament
Registration closes	When matches are scheduled for that division
After playoffs start	No new registrations for that tournament

Account vs tournament: Login as (Singles/Doubles) on the user account is set at registration and is not changed when playing doubles in a tournament or when admin assigns a partner.

7. Match Scheduling Rules (Summary)

Rule	Detail
Play days	Monday – Saturday
Off day	Sunday — no matches
Weekly structure	One round per week; max one match per player
Odd players	Bye week — no match that round
Auto schedule	One button schedules all subgroups
Reschedule	Date changes trigger email to players
Same dates re-scheduled	No duplicate email
Cancel all	Deletes division schedule + emails players

8. Playoffs Rules (Summary)

Rule	Detail
Unlock	After at least one group match result
Paths	Auto from standings; admin can adjust
Playoff start	Must be after group matches end
Short tournament window	Extend tournament first or see warning
After playoffs start	Group match scheduling locked
Playoff close	Results locked

9. Payment Flow

Player payment

- **Stripe** on Register or Choose League
- Successful payment → registered in tournament
- Admin can view Payment History

Admin-assigned players

- Players who registered online have payment records
- Admin subgroup assignment does not require a separate payment step

10. Charity

Public

- [/charity](#) — charity page
- Donate (Stripe) or submit material/volunteer form

Admin

- Manage charity causes

- View donations
- Send bulk email to donors

11. Email Notifications

All emails use a **branded template** (PTL logo, green header, consistent layout).

Event	Recipient
New account (admin-created)	Player — login details
Registration confirmed	Player
Doubles partner added	Partner — account setup link
Password reset	User — reset link
Match scheduled	Home + away players
Match rescheduled	Affected players
All matches cancelled	All players in division
Playoff match scheduled	Qualified players
Charity message	Donors

Note: Match emails are queued — a queue worker should run on the server. Set `APP_URL` in `.env` so the logo displays correctly in emails.

12. Complete Season — Example

Tournament: PTL Spring 2026

Week	Admin	Player
Week 0	Create tournament, attach divisions, assign subgroups/partners	Players register online

Week 1	Set group start date, schedule matches	Matches appear in My Matches
Week 2–8	Monitor results, check Points	Play weekly; upload photo, enter score
Week 9	Set group end date, review Qualifier	—
Week 10	Set playoff dates, schedule playoffs	Playoff matches appear
Week 11–12	Advance winners, run Final	Play playoff matches
Week 13	Playoff close, finish tournament	—

13. Common Problems & Solutions

Problem	What to do
Matches won't schedule	Check: tournament dates set? 2+ players per subgroup? Group start date?
Group end date won't save	Tournament end date too early — extend via Edit Tournament
Playoffs won't schedule	Extend tournament, complete group matches, save qualifier paths
Player doesn't see match	Admin scheduled? Player in correct subgroup?
Can't enter score	Upload match photo first
No email received	Check mail config and queue worker on server
Registration closed	Matches already scheduled for that division
Partner not in dropdown	Partner may already be paired, or in a different subgroup

14. Admin Panel — Page Reference

Menu	Purpose
Dashboard	Overview counts
Tournaments	Create / edit / manage tournaments
Groups	Subgroup templates
Subgroups	Divisions (skill + format)
Players	All players, search, active tournaments, login-as type
Payment History	Online payments
Charity Causes	Campaign management
Charity Donations	Donations + email
Announcements	Site announcements

Inside a tournament (per division)

Tab	Purpose
Subgroups & Players	Roster, partner assignment (doubles), subgroup moves
All Players	Division roster view
Matches	Schedule + results
Points	Standings
Qualifier	Playoff paths
Playoffs	Bracket + results

15. Player Portal — Page Reference

Section	Purpose
Personal Information	Profile, skill level, active tournaments with dates
Choose League	Join more tournaments
Password & Security	Password change
My Matches	Schedule, venue, scores (active tournaments)
Upload Image	Match photos

Public (no login)

Page	Purpose
<code>/league/{name}</code>	Tournament overview
<code>/league/{name}/{division}</code>	Standings + schedule + playoffs
<code>/charity</code>	Donations

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